Visual Studio LIVE!
EXPERT SOLUTIONS FOR ENTERPRISE DEVELOPERS
Las Vegas

# A Developers Guide to Failure

**Semira Allen**
**Manager, MLOps**
**Grainger**

Level: Beginner

# Session Survey

- Your feedback is very important to us
- Please take a moment to complete the session survey found in the mobile app
- Use the QR code or search for “Converge360 Events” in your app store
- Find this session on the Agenda tab
- Click “Session Evaluation”
- Thank you!

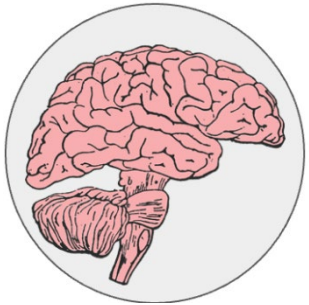
# Hey! I’m Semira

Visual Studio LIVE!
EXPERT SOLUTIONS FOR ENTERPRISE DEVELOPERS

# Key Takeaways

Failure as Feedback

How to Learn From Failure



Resilience Safety Net

Psychological Safety is Non-Negotiable

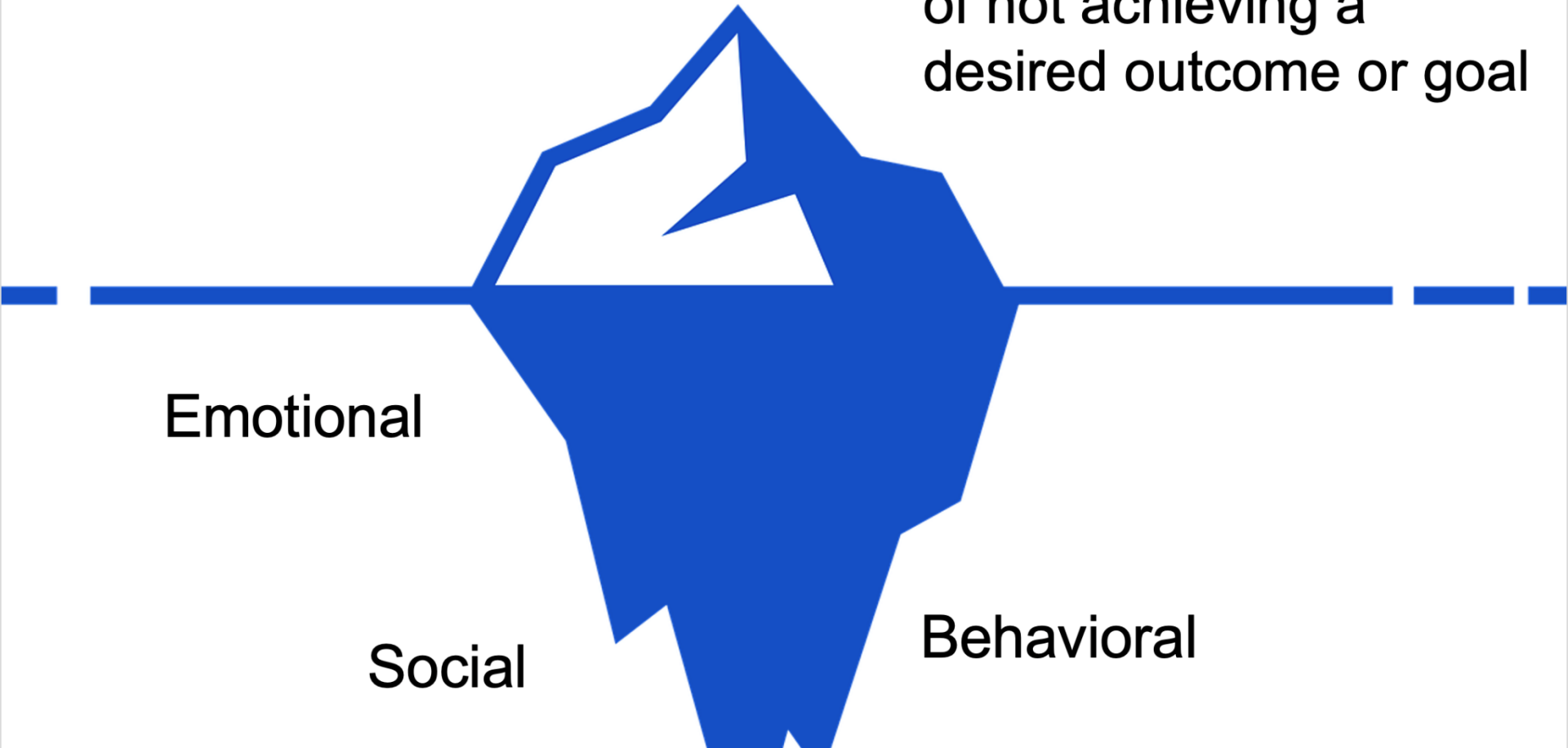
Visual Studio LIVE!
EXPERT SOLUTIONS FOR ENTERPRISE DEVELOPERS

Innovation **dies** with fear. Teams won't take risks if they're punished for mistakes.

"The belief that one will not be **punished** or **humiliated** for speaking up with ideas, questions, concerns, or mistakes, and that the team is safe for interpersonal risk taking"

-Amy Edmondson professor of leadership and management at harvard business school

Failure: The experience of not achieving a desired outcome or goal



# Most people struggle to learn from failure

## Why?

**Emotional: the experience of failure threatens a person's sense of self worth**

**"You think failing is hard, so is learning from it"** by Dr. Lauren Eskreis-Winkler and Dr. Ayelet Fishbach

**Cognitive: as humans we tend to seek out information that agrees with our beliefs and expectations (aka confirmation bias)**

# How do we overcome this barrier?

01

**Learning from others**

02

**Soliciting external feedback**

03

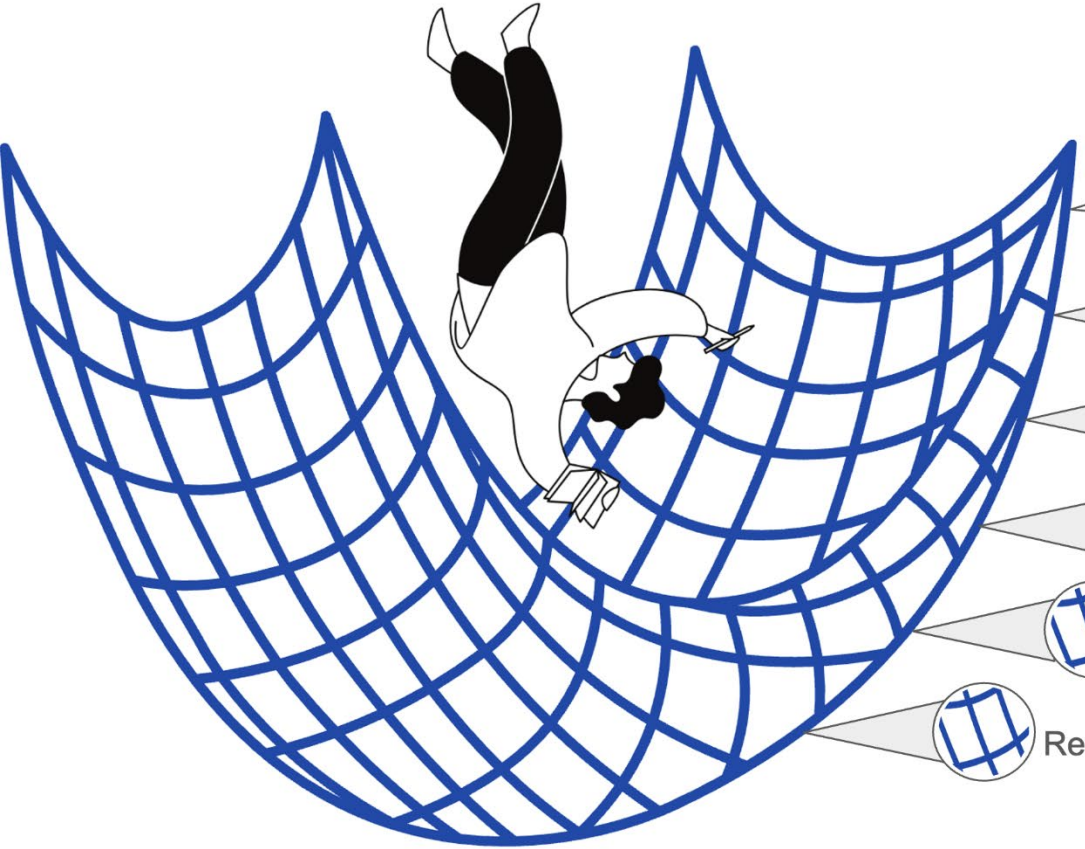
**Focus on Controllable factors**

04

**Deliberate reflection**

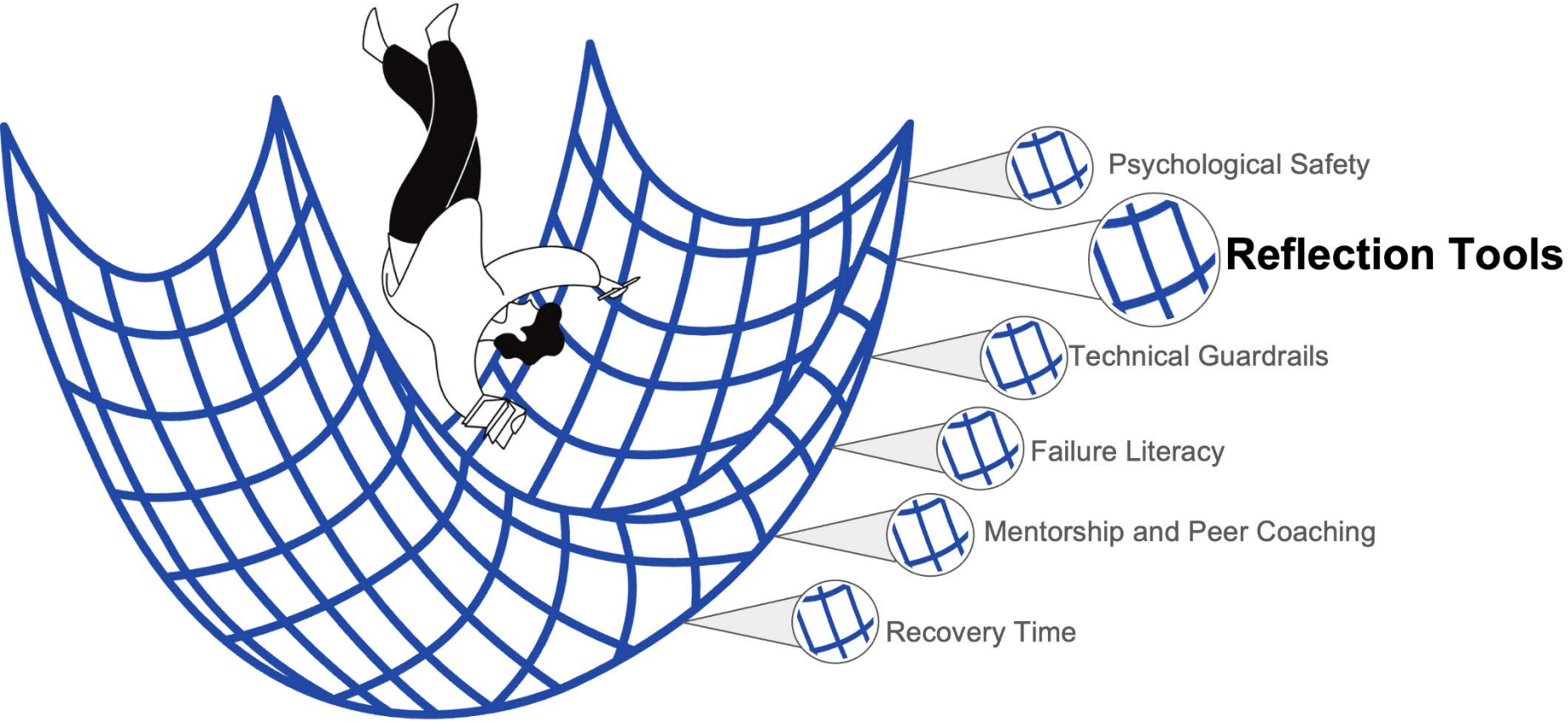
# The Retrospective That Saved My Job

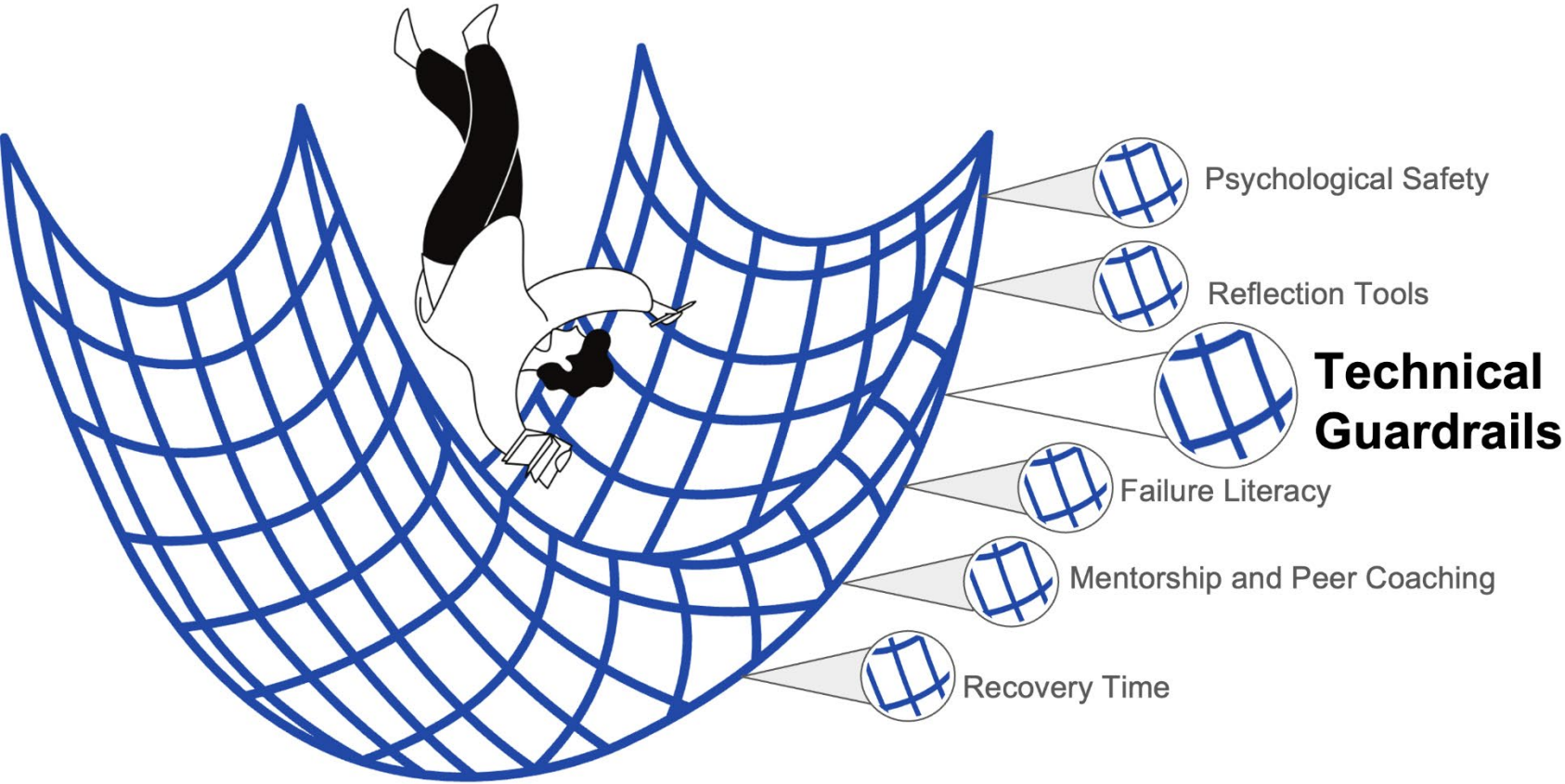
Visual Studio LIVE!
EXPERT SOLUTIONS FOR ENTERPRISE DEVELOPERS

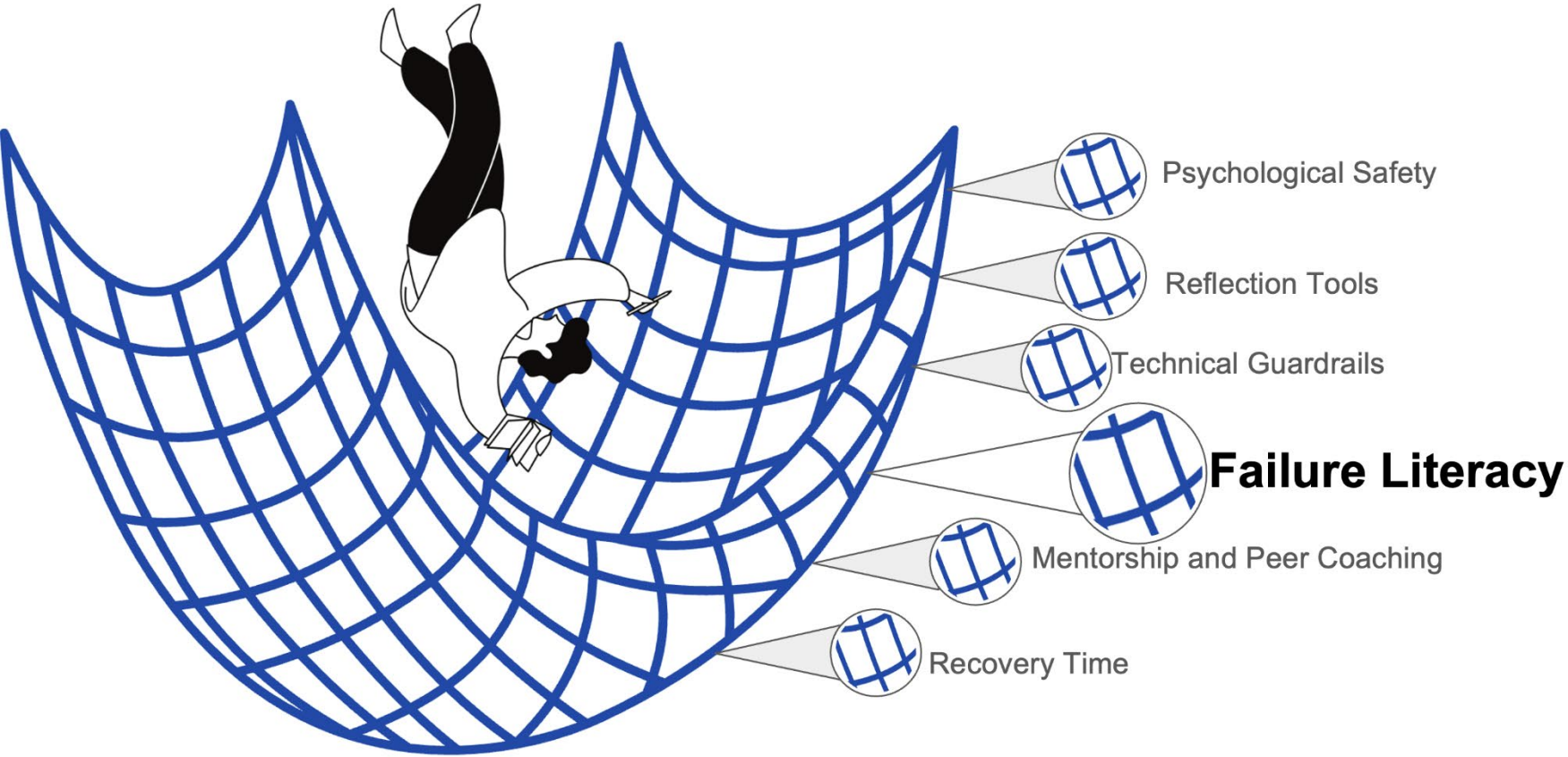


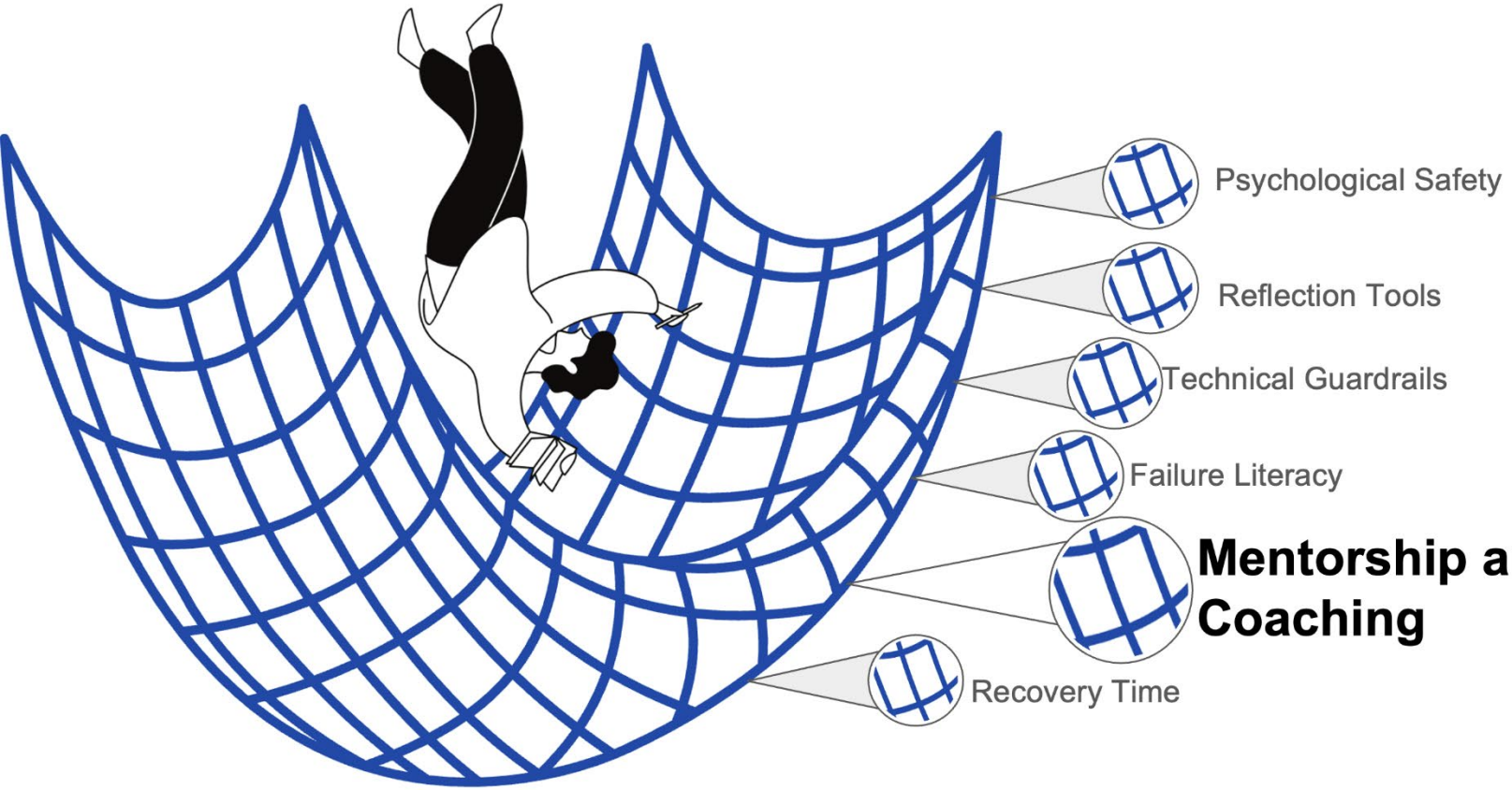
## Psychological Safety

- Reflection Tools
- Technical Guardrails
- Failure Literacy
- Mentorship and Peer Coaching
- Recovery Time

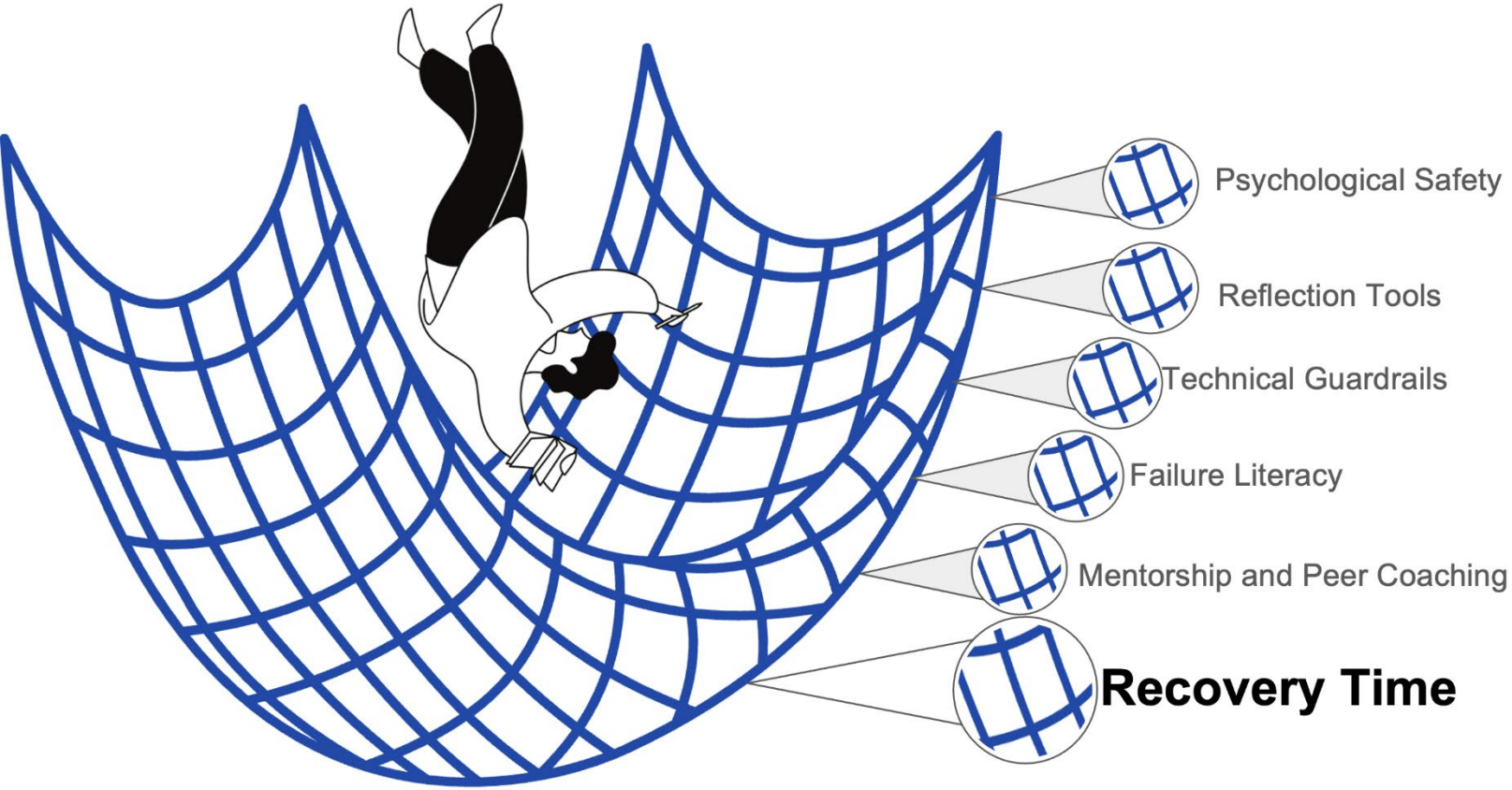

Psychological Safety
Reflection Tools
Technical Guardrails
Failure Literacy
Mentorship and Peer Coaching
Recovery Time


Psychological Safety
Reflection Tools
Technical Guardrails
Failure Literacy
Mentorship and Peer Coaching
Recovery Time


Psychological Safety
Reflection Tools
Technical Guardrails
Failure Literacy
Mentorship and Peer Coaching
Recovery Time




Visual Studio LIVE!
EXPERT SOLUTIONS FOR ENTERPRISE DEVELOPERS


Psychological Safety
Reflection Tools
Technical Guardrails
Failure Literacy
Mentorship and Peer Coaching
Recovery Time

# Activity: Building Your Safety Net

# Activity: Building Your Safety Net

**1. Warm-up (2 mins) – "Failure Flashback"**

- A time you or your team experienced a failure at work.
- Or reflect on a major failure in the media (ex. Crowdstrike)

# Activity: Building Your Safety Net

**2. Safety Net Mapping (5 minutes)**

**Resilience Safety Net Components**:

1. Psychological Safety
2. Structured Reflection Tools
3. Failure Literacy Training
4. Technical Guardrails
5. Mentorship & Peer Coaching
6. Recovery Time & Recognition

**Instructions**:

- Break into small groups .
- Ask:
  - ✅ What *do we already have* in this area?
  - ⚠️ What's *missing or inconsistent*?

# Activity: Building Your Safety Net

**Resilience Safety Net Components**:

1. Psychological Safety
2. Structured Reflection Tools
3. Failure Literacy Training
4. Technical Guardrails
5. Mentorship & Peer Coaching
6. Recovery Time & Recognition

**4. Action Planning (5 mins)**

Each person or group chooses *one category* where they want to strengthen their net.

- What *small change* could we pilot this sprint or month?
- What support (tools, people, permission) do we need?
- How will we know it helped?

# On Monday Morning

- Normalize talking about failure
- Identify one thing missing from your teams safety net

Visual Studio LIVE!
EXPERT SOLUTIONS FOR ENTERPRISE DEVELOPERS

🚫 **Failure Isn’t the Enemy, It’s the Input.**

🧠 **Learning from Failure is Intentional**

🕸️ **Design a Resilience Safety Net**

Visual Studio LIVE!
EXPERT SOLUTIONS FOR ENTERPRISE DEVELOPERS

# Let's keep the conversation going!